

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 8 4
 ♥ 9 7 3
 ♦ 10 8 7 2
 ♣ A 6 5 3

♠ A 10 7 5

♥ A 8 2

♦ K Q

♣ K 8 7 4



♠ K 6 2

♥ 10 6 4

♦ A J 6 5 4

♣ 9 2

♠ Q J 9 3

♥ K Q J 5

♦ 9 3

♣ Q J 10

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North

then he only has 4 red cards, and he would not have opened 1NT with either 5-4-2-2 or 5-4-3-1 distribution.

[showcards W:C9 N:CT]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♣9,
 dummy played the ♣10

Play the ♣6.

Partner's ♣9 is likely from a short suit. If it is a singleton, you should take the ♣A immediately and return the suit for a ruff. If it is a doubleton, you should NOT take your ♣A now, but should hope partner can get the lead and play his second ♣ to your Ace so you can give him the ruff.

You can figure out which it is.

If it is a singleton, then North must hold 5 ♣s. But you know North has 4 ♠s, so if he also has 5 ♣s

So partner's ♣9 is not a singleton, and you should wait. Declarer then runs dummy's ♠Q. Partner wins the ♠K, returns his OTHER ♣ to your ♣A, and NOW you give him the ruff. He takes the ♦A for down 1.

Board 4

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6 5 2

♥ J 9 8

♦ 9 5

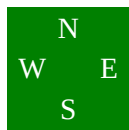
♣ K J 10 9 7

♠ Q J 9 7

♥ K Q 6 5 3

♦ 10

♣ A 6 4



♠ A K 4

♥ A 7 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ Q 5 2

♠ 10 8 3

♥ 10 2

♦ Q J 8 6 4 2

♣ 8 3

*West**North**East**South*

2♣

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

enter dummy and he will never get to enjoy those two ♣ winners.

[showcards W:HT N:HJ]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥10, dummy played the ♥J

Play the ♥6.

Declarer gets two ♥ winners whether you play one of your honors on this trick or not. So why does it matter what you do?

Suppose you cover with your ♥Q. East will win his ♥A, then play ♣s until your ♣A is forced out on the third round. He can then force an entry to dummy in the ♥ suit to reach the two ♣ winners.

Now suppose you duck the ♥J. Again East will push ♣s, and again you hold up until the third round. Ahh, what a difference. Now declarer cannot use the ♥s to